

How often is food with a good Nutri-Score ultra-processed?

Nutri-Score and NOVA in 23,310 packaged foods listed for Switzerland, compared with Germany and France
Open Food Facts • 1.72 million products listed in CH, DE or FR • September 2026 snapshot

Report conclusion. Among products listed for Switzerland with both classifications, three in ten rated Nutri-Score A or B are NOVA 4. The share varies strongly by food group; Germany and France show a similar pattern.

FIGURE A · OVERLAP

29%

of A/B products listed for Switzerland with both classifications are NOVA 4 (ultra-processed).
1,673 of 5,758 (95% CI 28–30%). A: 23%, B: 37%

FIGURE A · ASSOCIATION

$\rho = 0.40$

rank correlation between Nutri-Score points and NOVA group: a moderate association.
95% CI 0.39–0.42; by grade 0.38. Germany 0.45, France 0.39

FIGURE C · COMPARISON

26% and 30%

of A/B products are NOVA 4 in Germany and France.
Check: 13.5% of French NOVA 4 products are rated A/B (12.5% published [2])

What this means for reading a label

A good Nutri-Score describes the **nutrient profile**, not the **processing level**. The two labels answer different questions, so one cannot replace the other. The overlap is largest for **sweets, dairy desserts, milk and yogurt, and bread**.

These data describe labels, not health effects of processing.

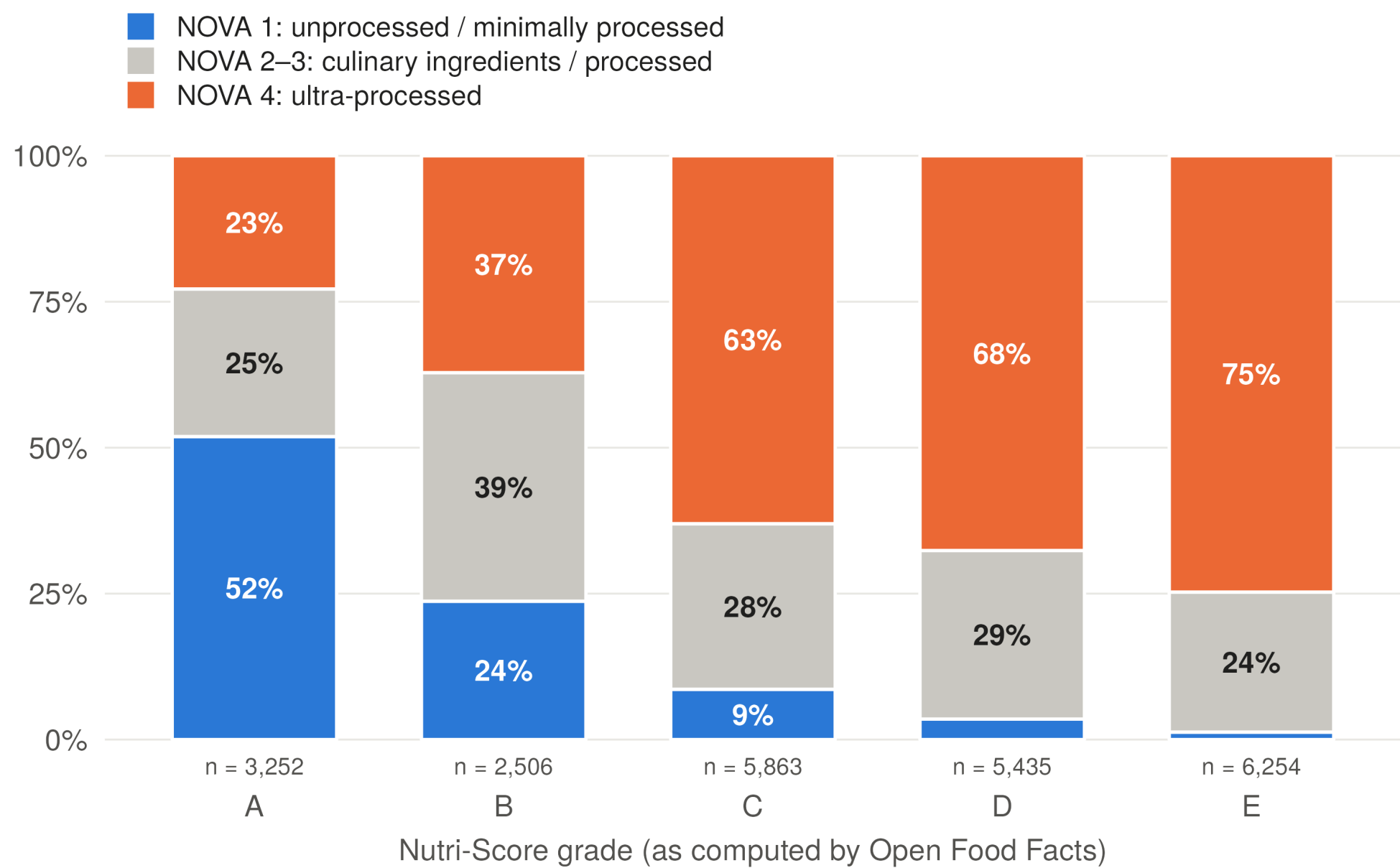
What these data cannot show

- **The market.** Product counts, not sales; 22% of listed Swiss products have both scores.
- **Expert NOVA groups.** NOVA is assigned automatically here; even experts classify inconsistently [3].
- **Health effects.**

FOUR VIEWS OF THE EVIDENCE

A Even grade A holds 23% NOVA 4 products.

n = 23,310



Share NOVA 4: grade A 23% (95% CI 21–24%), B 37% (35–39%), E 75% (74–76%).

C Germany and France show a similar gradient.

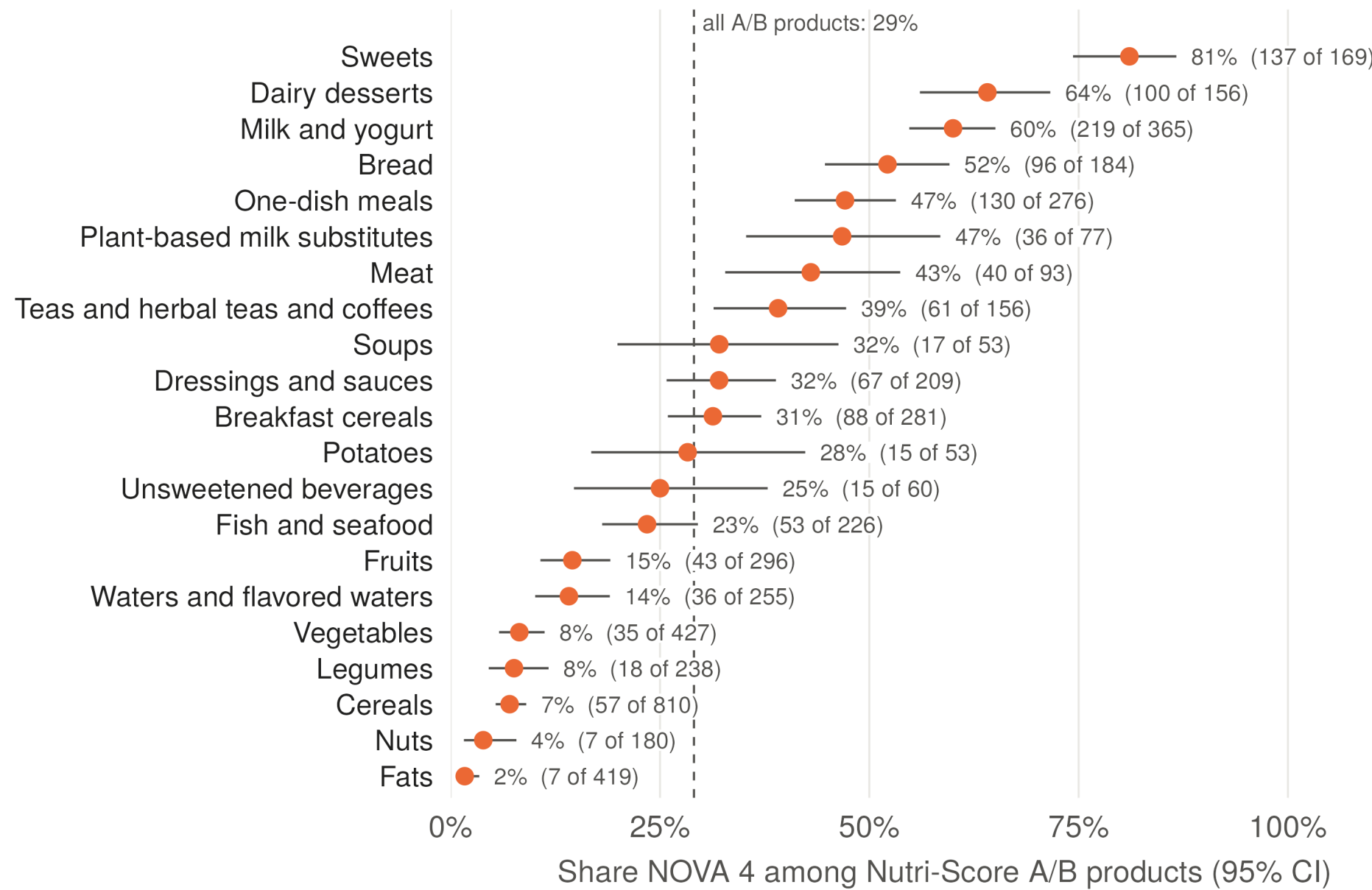
n = 23k–268k



Samples overlap: 56% of Swiss A/B products are also listed in DE or FR. A/B products listed in one country only: CH 31%, DE 27%, FR 30%; standardised to a common food-group mix: 26%, 25%, 28%.

B The overlap varies strongly by food group.

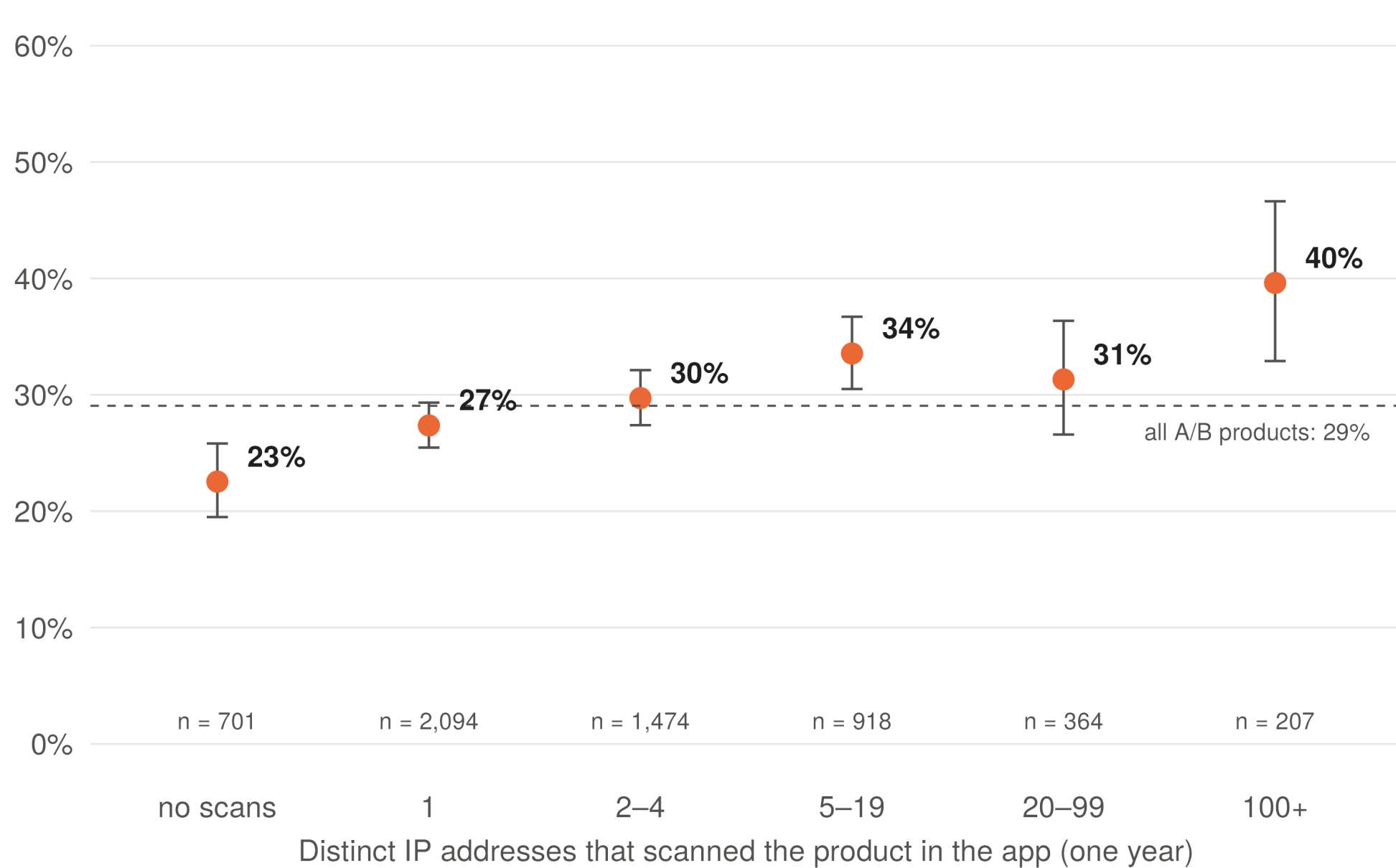
n = 53–810 per group



Food groups with ≥ 50 A/B products. Not shown: 446 uncategorised products (51% NOVA 4).

D The share is not lower among often-scanned products.

n = 5,758



Scans: distinct IP addresses using the Open Food Facts app in one year. Odds ratio per doubling 1.07 (95% CI 1.04–1.10); within food groups 1.03 (0.99–1.06).

Background

Nutri-Score (A–E) rates the nutrient profile; it is voluntary in Switzerland, and its algorithm was updated in 2022–23. **NOVA** groups foods from unprocessed (1) to ultra-processed (4).

Earlier studies with the same database: in Spain, 26% of grade-A products were NOVA 4 (old algorithm) [1]; in France, 12.5% of NOVA 4 products were rated A/B after the update [2].

Data & definitions

Products in the Open Food Facts export	4,535,553
Listed for Switzerland	103,612
... with Nutri-Score and NOVA group	23,310
Germany / France with both	85,866 / 267,990

Export of 24 September 2026. Both classifications as computed by Open Food Facts from declared nutrients and ingredients.

Methods & limitations

Clopper–Pearson CIs, bootstrap CIs for ρ and standardisation, logistic regression.

- **Selected pages:** products with both scores are not a random sample.
- **Headline:** 27–31% under six restrictions; 40% (34–46%) weighted by scans.
- **One snapshot;** labels printed on packs may differ.